

Elena’s Thesis

Sailing and Mapping



When I am on a sailing boat,

I close my eyes, and I imagine worlds, mountains, reefs, creatures, ship wrecks and spirits that lie underneath me.

I open my eyes, and I explore paper maps, phone maps, tablet maps, imaginary maps, digital lines, trajectories, sea foam maps, shapes that point at rocks...



I will sail the Atlantic this summer, and cross it from East to West in November 2026.

Sea Maps - Uncharted territories



Large portions of the ocean floor remain unmapped and we know more about the surface of the moon than about the bottom of the ocean.

How do we represent spaces that we cannot see?



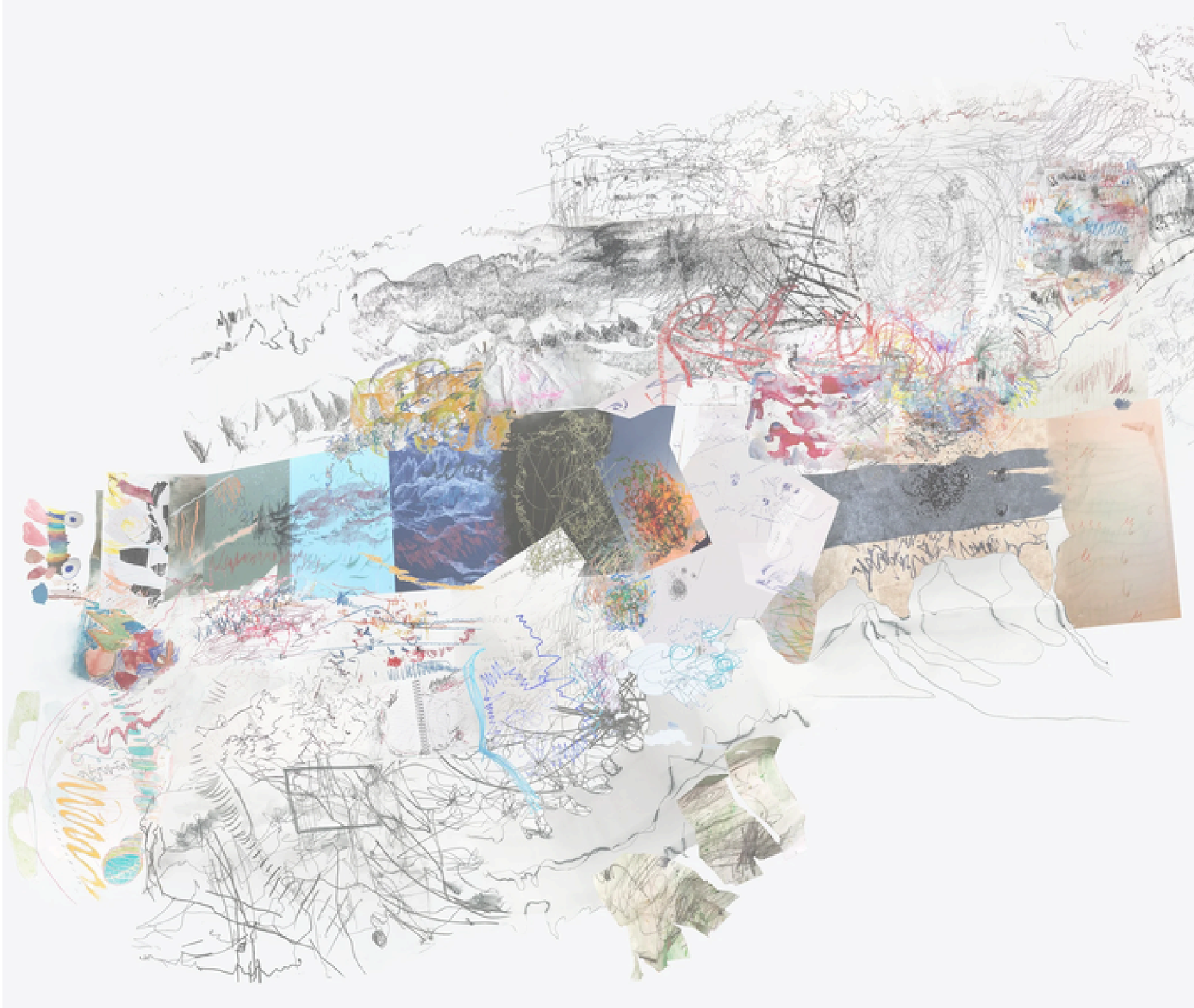
Marie Tharp (1920-2006): the ocean floor is not flat.

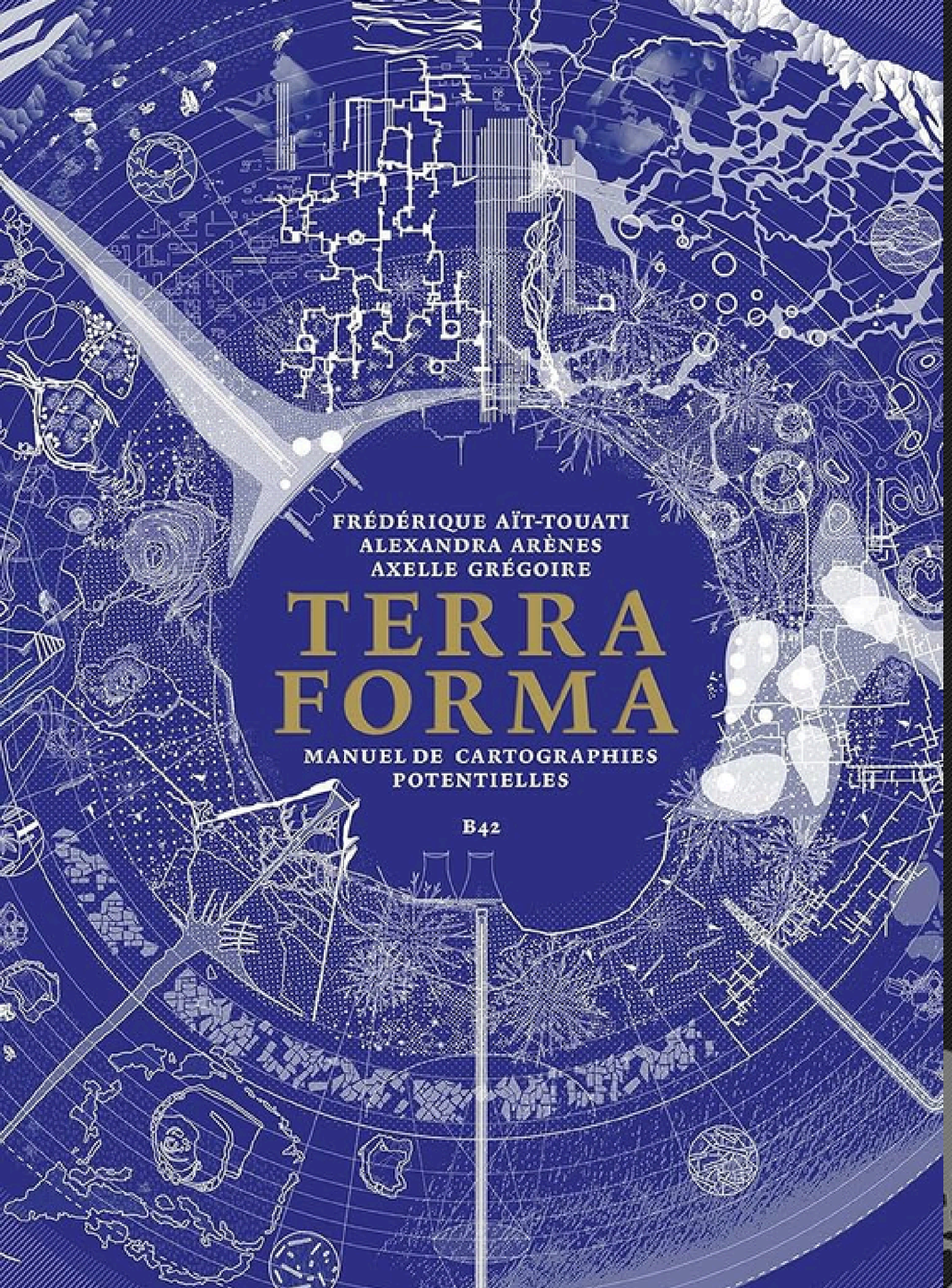
Speculative Cartography

No points of reference.

Constant movement.

Time component becomes essential.

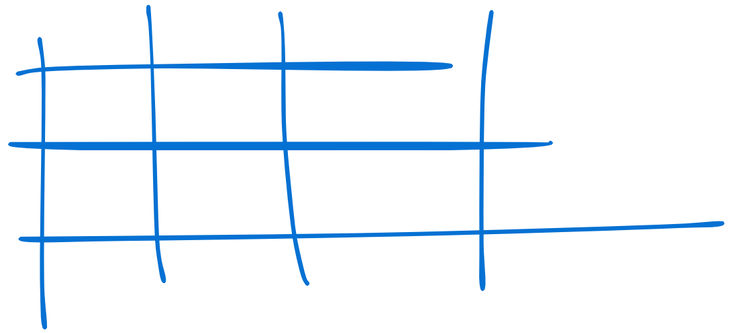



FRÉDÉRIQUE AÏT-TOUATI
ALEXANDRA ARÈNES
AXELLE GRÉGOIRE
TERRA FORMA
MANUEL DE CARTOGRAPHIES POTENTIELLES
B42


ATMOSPHERE
ALTERED ZONE
EXCAVATION
EROSION
ARTIFICIAL ROCKS

Layers - cohexistance of spaces

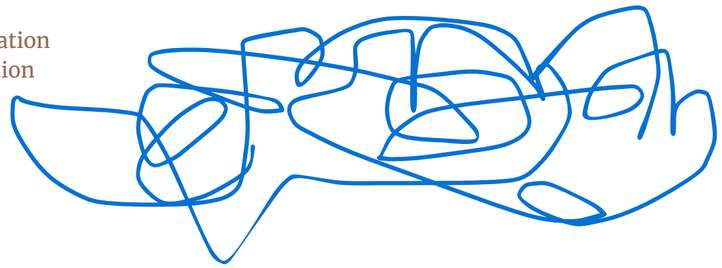
2D map

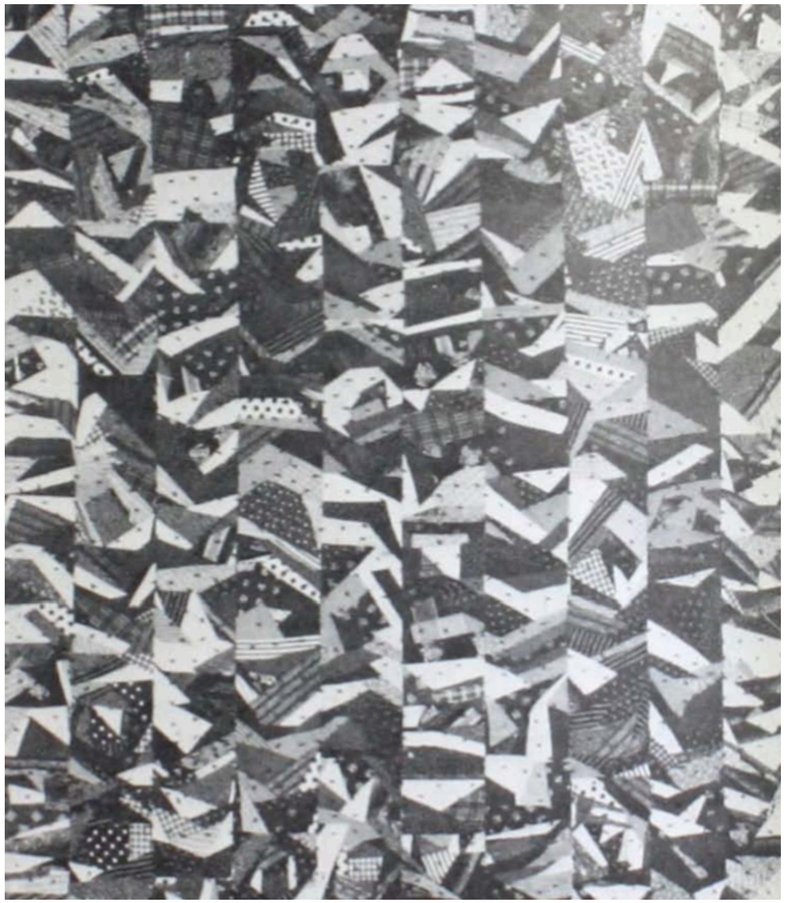


moving
environment



imagination
perception





DELEUZE, Gilles, GUATTARI, Félix and DELEUZE, Gilles, 1980. Mille plateaux. Paris : Éditions de minuit. Collection ‘Critique’, t. 2. ISBN 978-2-7073-0307-3.

The deeper,
the less
details,
the more
imperfect

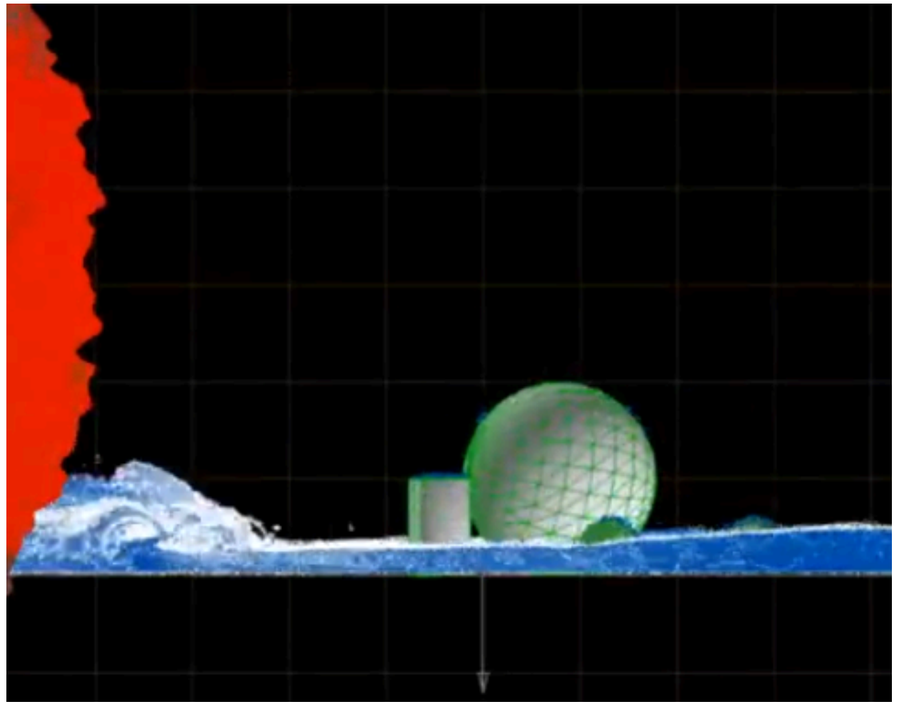
limit between visible and invisible



“Hic sunt dracones”

Seafloor Futures

Science and Fictions in Deep Dimensions



Tabita Rezaire , “Deep Down Tidal”





Maritime tools



Maritime tools



Maritime tools



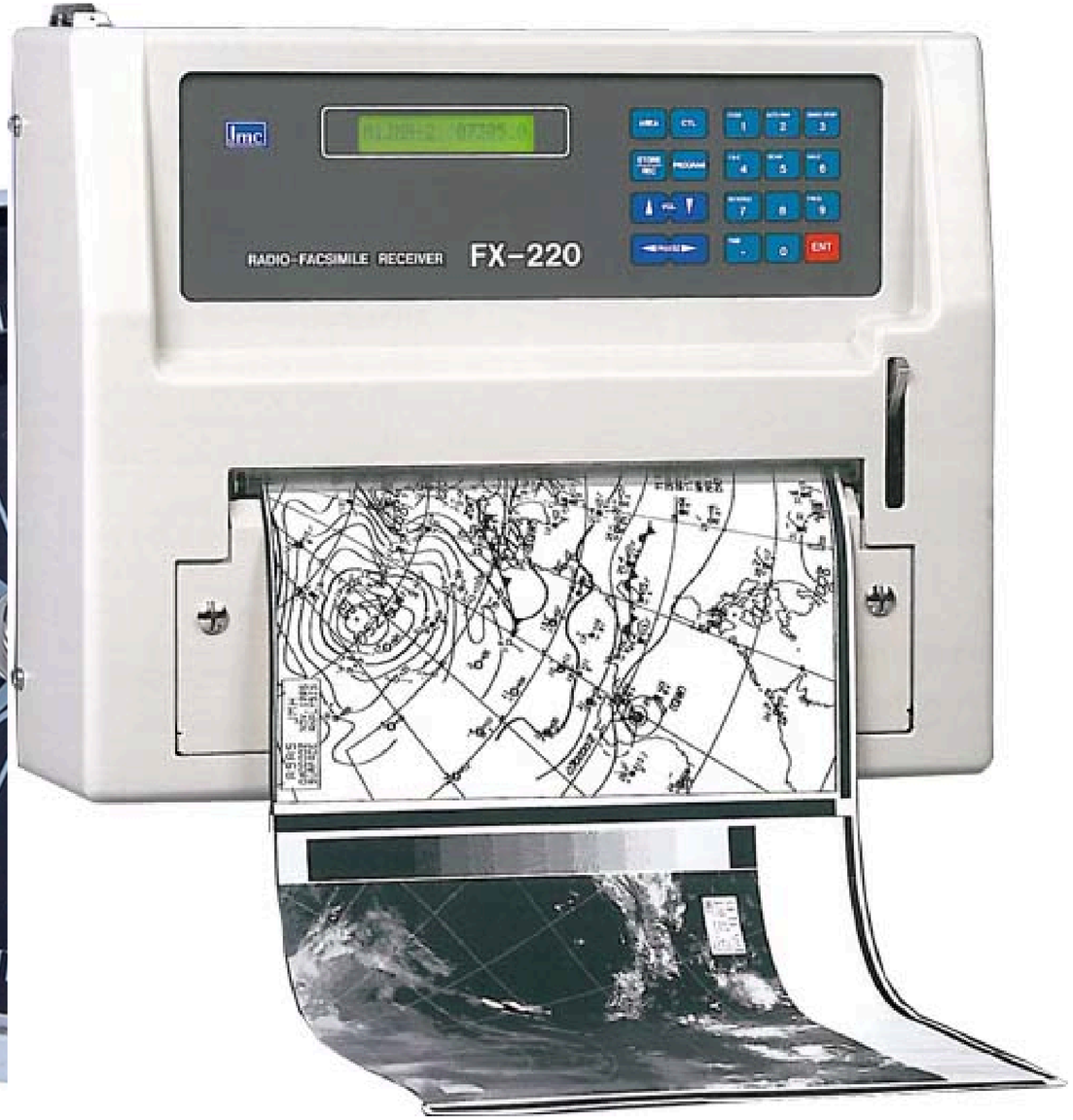


Maritime tools









Contraints at sea

low energy

weather

limited space

salt water, salt air

constant movement

no internet

DIY electronics on board

Technological creation can emerge from conditions of limitation, instability, and resource awareness

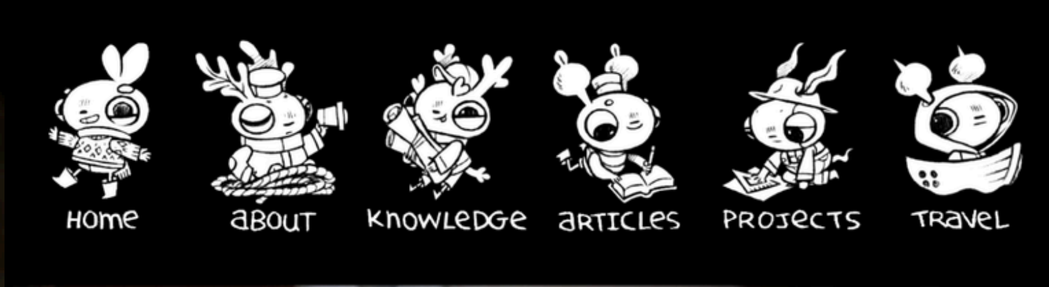


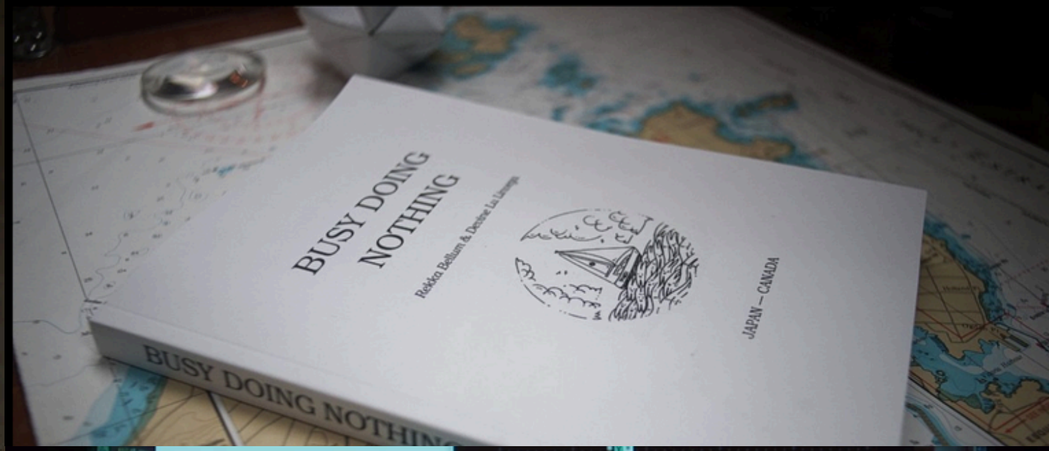
100Rabbits

DIY electronics on board



This is Rekka's writing station, it’s also the Raspberry Pi, with the small screen, this

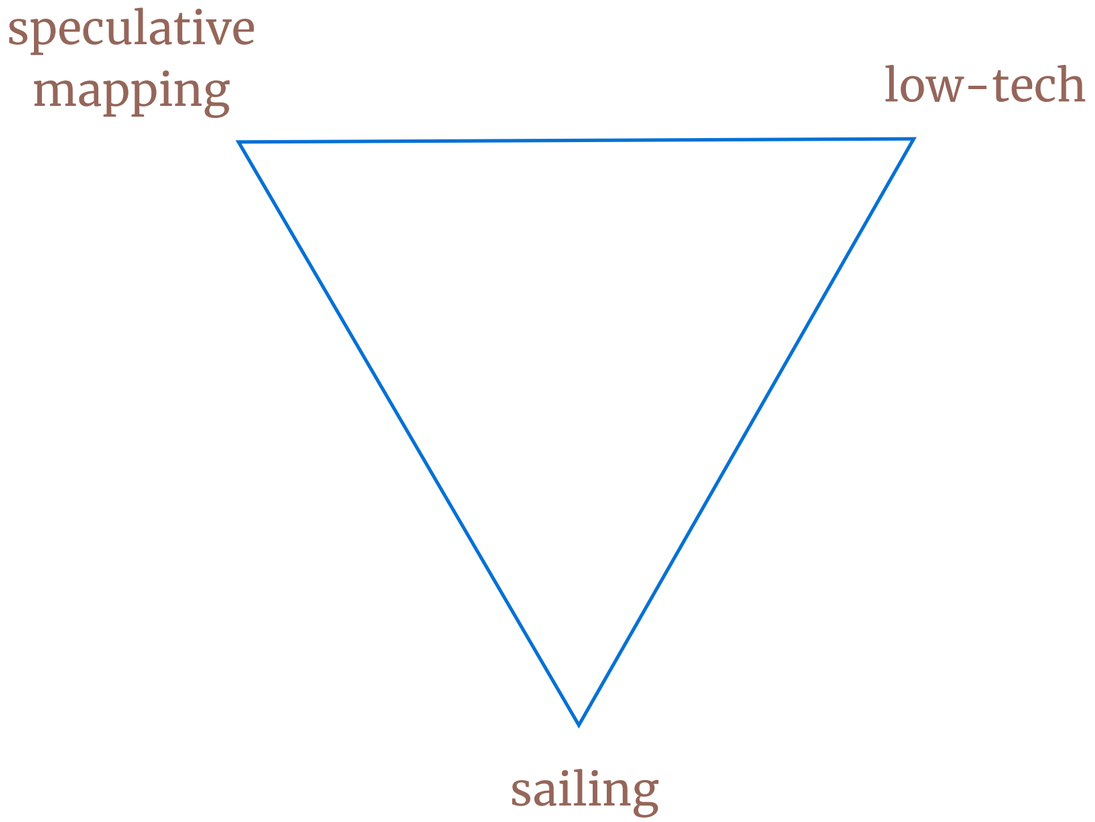






And these three things are: To write simple modular parts connected with clean interfaces.

Towards a research question...



Research Question(s)

A sailing boat can be understood as a laboratory for experimental ways of perceiving and mapping a space that is dynamic in nature.

Within this constrained environment, maritime tools that resist seawater, humidity and harsh weather conditions can serve as inspiration to imagine low-tech instruments for sensing, recording, and representing the ocean beyond conventional cartographic systems.

How can low-tech practices developed within the constrained environment of a sailing boat generate alternative maritime cartographies?

- How can imprecision in oceanic data generate poetic cartographies?
- How can sailing trajectories be used to construct alternative mappings of invisible oceanic space?

Methodology

READ/RESEARCH

- Research on mapping.
- Research on alternative data visualisations.
- Research on critical engineering.
- Research online how people build low-tech related to water, to recording, to mapping.
- CCC conferences.

ON BOARD: SEA/PORTS

- Look for interesting objects on sailing boats.
- Start recording water data and find methods to classify them in a personal way.
- Interview other women on the boat with me.
- Speak with people on sailing boat.
- Participant observation.

INTERVIEW

- Interview people on sailing boats.
- Interview cartographers.
- Interviews philosophers on matters of representing the invisible.
- Interview 100Rabbits
- Interview a friend who works on maritime law on pirates.

Planning

August: sail
Portugal, Madeira,
Canaries.

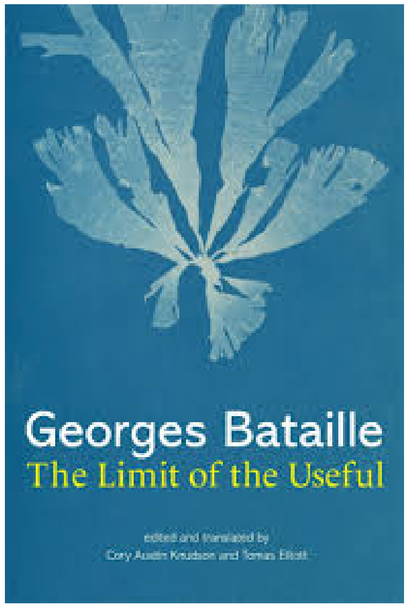
observations,
meetings, join low
tech gatherings

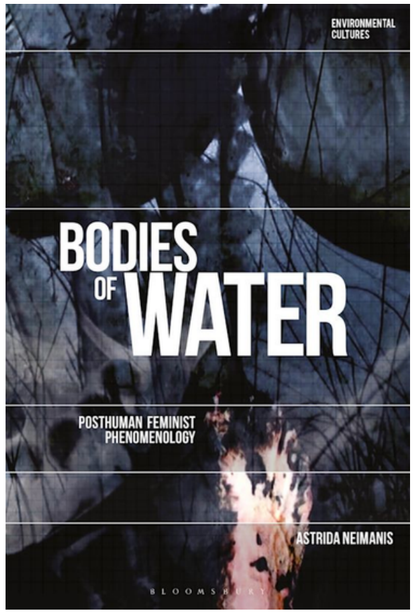
November:
Atlantic
crossing.

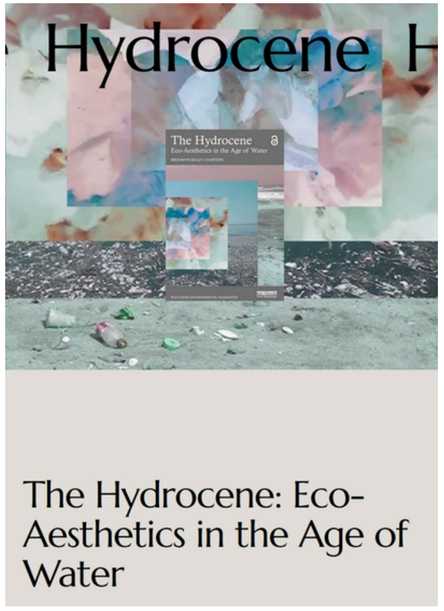
July-October: Internship
@ DotDotDot
Interviews with them and
Studio Folder.

NORBIT subsea to
potentially lend me
a mapping device

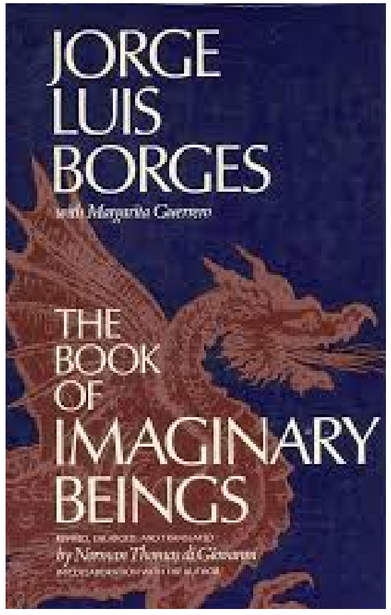
Venice: interview people
related to the TBA21–
Academy at Ocean Space.


Georges Bataille
The Limit of the Useful
edited and translated by
Cory Austin Knudsen and Tomas Elliott

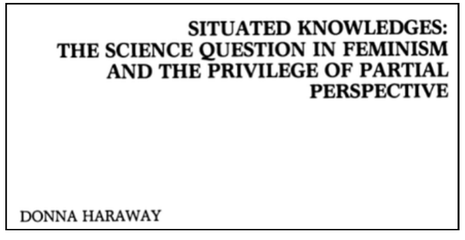

ENVIRONMENTAL CULTURES
BODIES OF WATER
POSTHUMAN FEMINIST PHENOMENOLOGY
ASTRIDA NEIMANIS
BLOOMSBURY


Hydrocene H
The Hydrocene
Eco-Aesthetics in the Age of Water
The Hydrocene: Eco-Aesthetics in the Age of Water

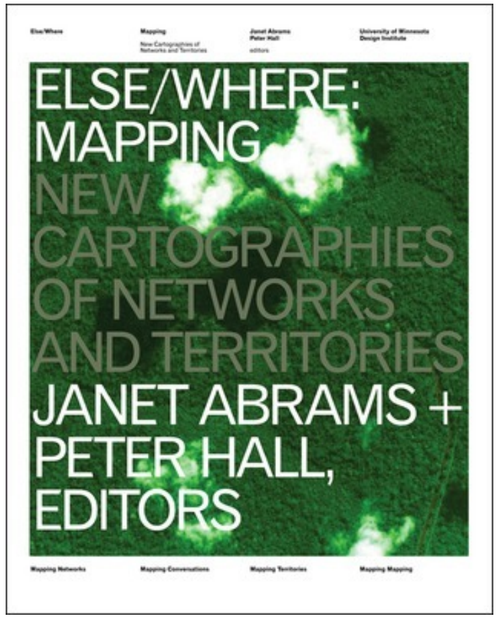

COLLECTION « CRITIQUE »
GILLES DELEUZE
FÉLIX GUATTARI
CAPITALISME ET SCHIZOPHRÉNIE 2
MILLE PLATEAUX
LES ÉDITIONS DE MINUIT

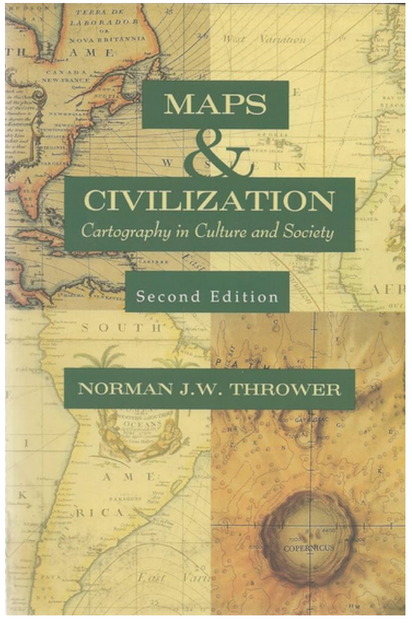

JORGE LUIS BORGES
with Margarita Guerrero
THE BOOK OF IMAGINARY BEINGS

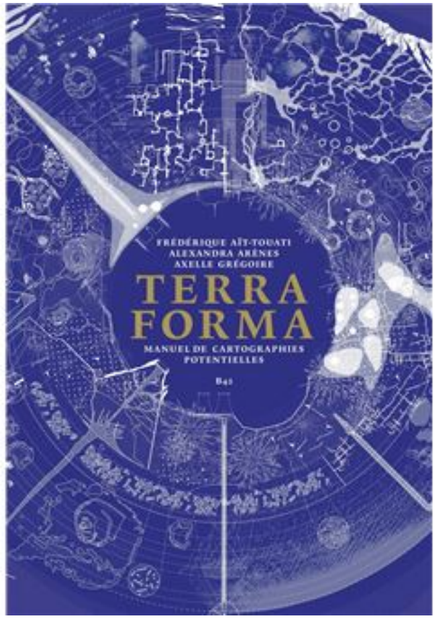

Chaos Computer Club


SITUATED KNOWLEDGES:
THE SCIENCE QUESTION IN FEMINISM
AND THE PRIVILEGE OF PARTIAL
PERSPECTIVE
DONNA HARAWAY


README


ELSE/WHERE:
MAPPING
NEW CARTOGRAPHIES OF NETWORKS AND TERRITORIES
JANET ABRAMS + PETER HALL, EDITORS


MAPS
&
CIVILIZATION
Cartography in Culture and Society
Second Edition
NORMAN J.W. THROWER


FRÉDÉRIQUE AÏT-TOUATI
ALEXANDRA ARÈNES
AXELLE GRÉGOIRE
TERRA FORMA
MANUEL DE CARTOGRAPHIES POTENTIELLES